

Streamlining IT Procurement

Automating Standard Laptop Orders with Flow Designer

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Problem Statement

- IT procurement lacks efficiency and automation, causing delays and manual overhead.
- Standard laptop orders need configuration, but this step is prone to oversight or delay.
- Users get frustrated waiting for devices that are not ready on arrival.
- IT department resources are allocated inefficiently.

Result: manual follow-ups, slower delivery, unhappy users

Our Idea: The User Story

“ *As a member of the IT procurement team, I want a streamlined process for ordering standard laptops so that tasks are automatically generated and assigned to the hardware team for configuration. This ensures laptops are promptly configured upon arrival, reducing user wait times and minimising manual intervention.* ”

Project Objectives

Seamless experience

Timely configuration for users requesting standard laptops

1

Less manual work

Reduce manual intervention and errors in procurement

2

Better utilisation

Optimise task allocation within the IT department

3

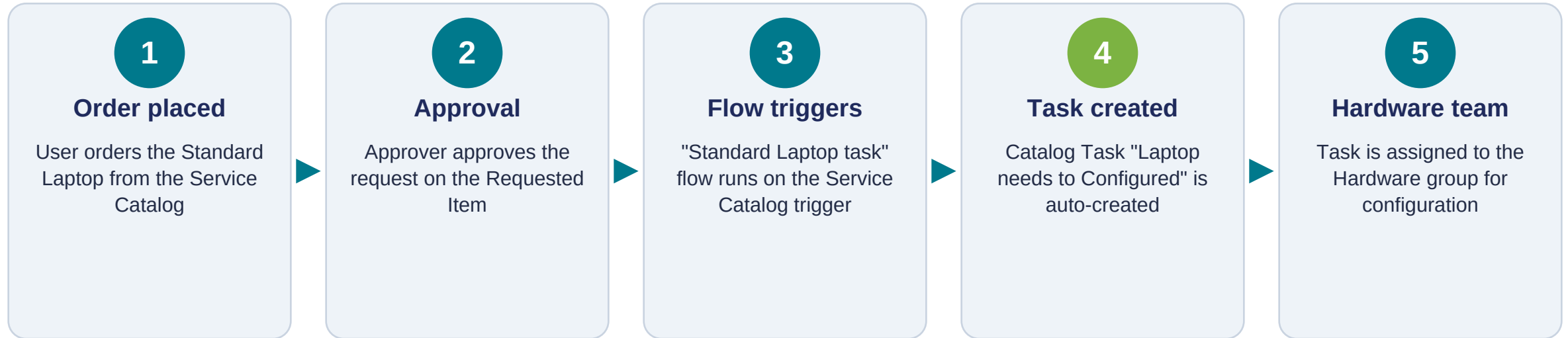
Higher efficiency

Boost productivity of IT procurement operations

4

How We Solve It

A Flow Designer flow attached to the Standard Laptop catalog item automates the hand-off to the hardware team.



Outcome

- No manual task creation, tasks are generated automatically
- Hardware team is notified the moment the laptop is approved

Tools & Technologies

ServiceNow

Cloud ITSM platform where the whole solution is built and run.

Flow Designer

Low-code Process Automation tool used to build the "Standard Laptop task" flow.

Service Catalog

Hardware category and Standard Laptop item (Lenovo Carbon x1) for ordering.

Maintain Items

Catalog Definitions module used to attach the flow in the item's Process Engine tab.

Create Catalog Task

ServiceNow Core action that creates the sc_task for the Hardware group.

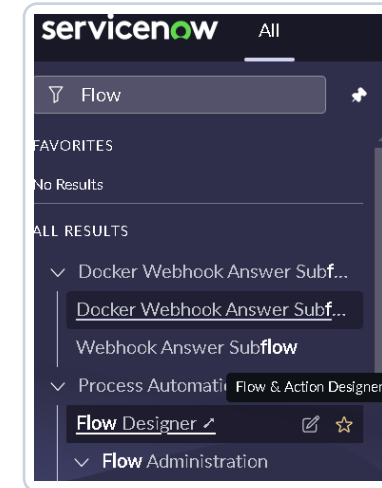
Approvals

Approver (Requests > Approvers) approves the request before fulfilment.

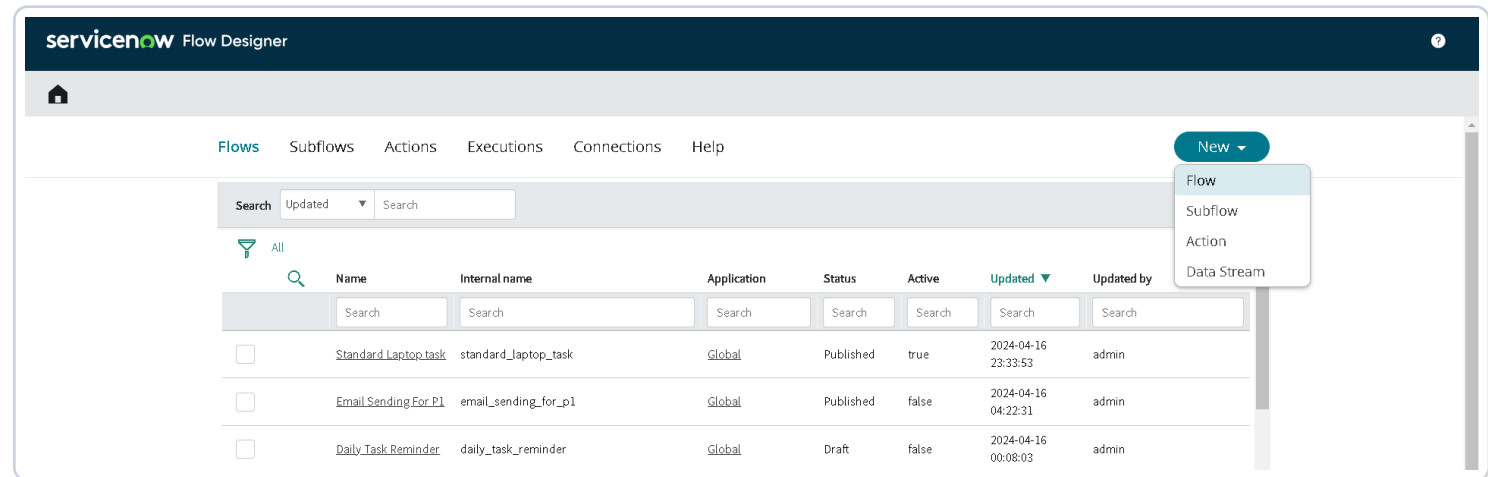
Step 1: Open Flow Designer

Milestone 1 | Create the Flow

- 1 Open ServiceNow.
- 2 Click All and search for Flow Designer.
- 3 Click Flow Designer under Process Automation.
- 4 In Flow Designer, click New and select Flow.



All > Flow Designer (Process Automation)

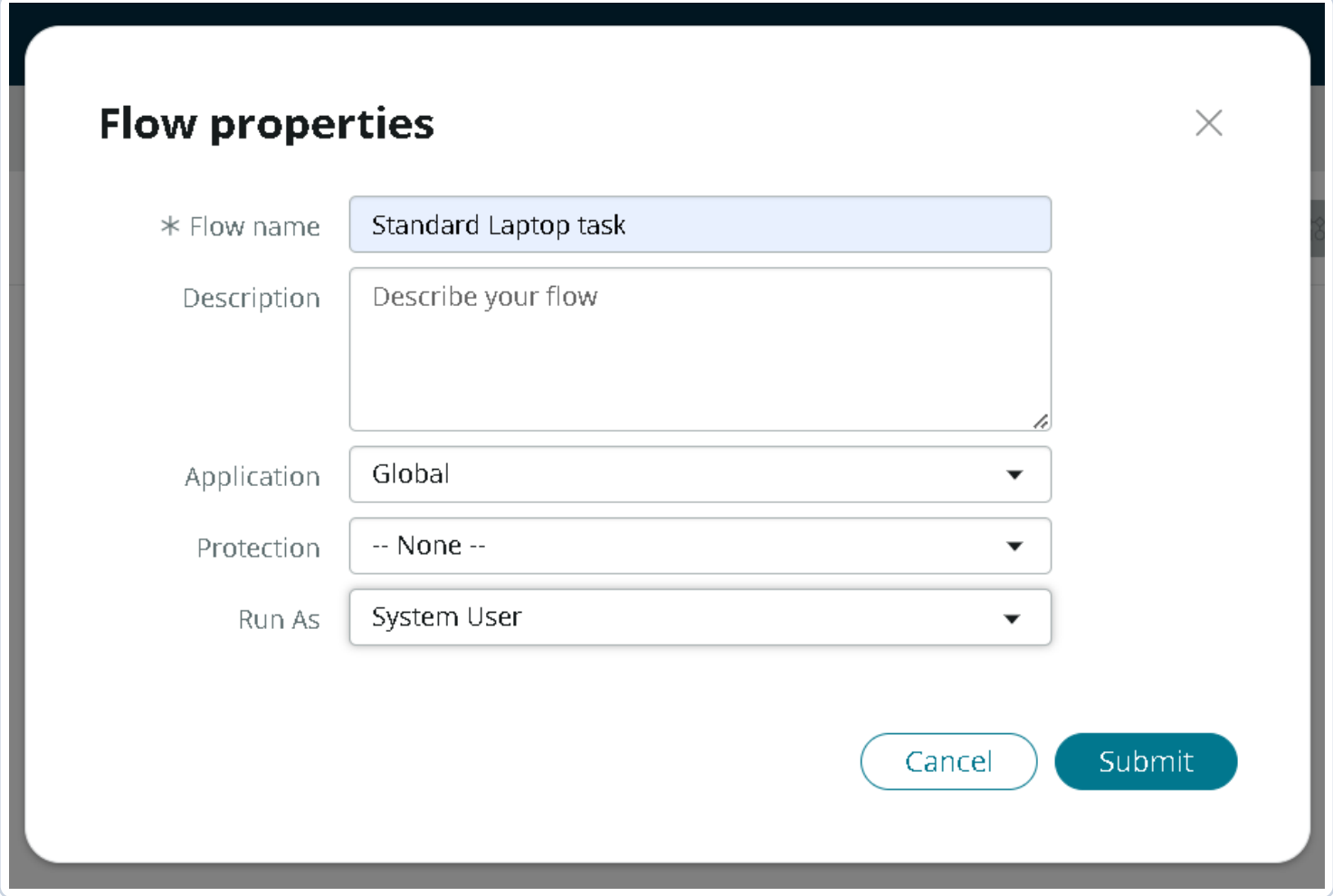


New > Flow

Step 2: Set Flow Properties

Milestone 1 | Create the Flow

- 5 Give the Flow name as "Standard laptop task".
- 6 Application should be Global.
- 7 Select Run As: System User.
- 8 Click Submit.

A screenshot of a 'Flow properties' dialog box. The dialog has a title bar with a close button (X) in the top right corner. Inside, there are five labeled input fields: '* Flow name' with the value 'Standard Laptop task', 'Description' with the placeholder 'Describe your flow', 'Application' with the value 'Global', 'Protection' with the value '-- None --', and 'Run As' with the value 'System User'. At the bottom right, there are two buttons: 'Cancel' and 'Submit'.

Flow properties

* Flow name: Standard Laptop task

Description: Describe your flow

Application: Global

Protection: -- None --

Run As: System User

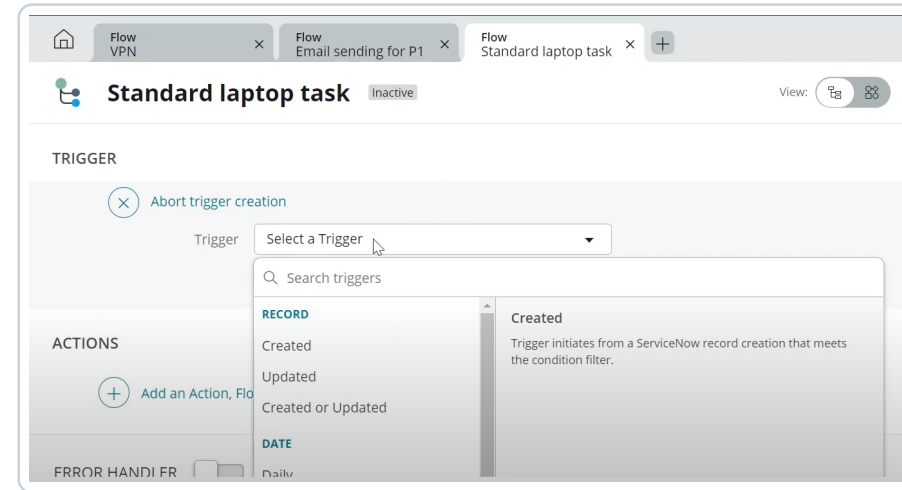
Cancel Submit

Flow properties dialog

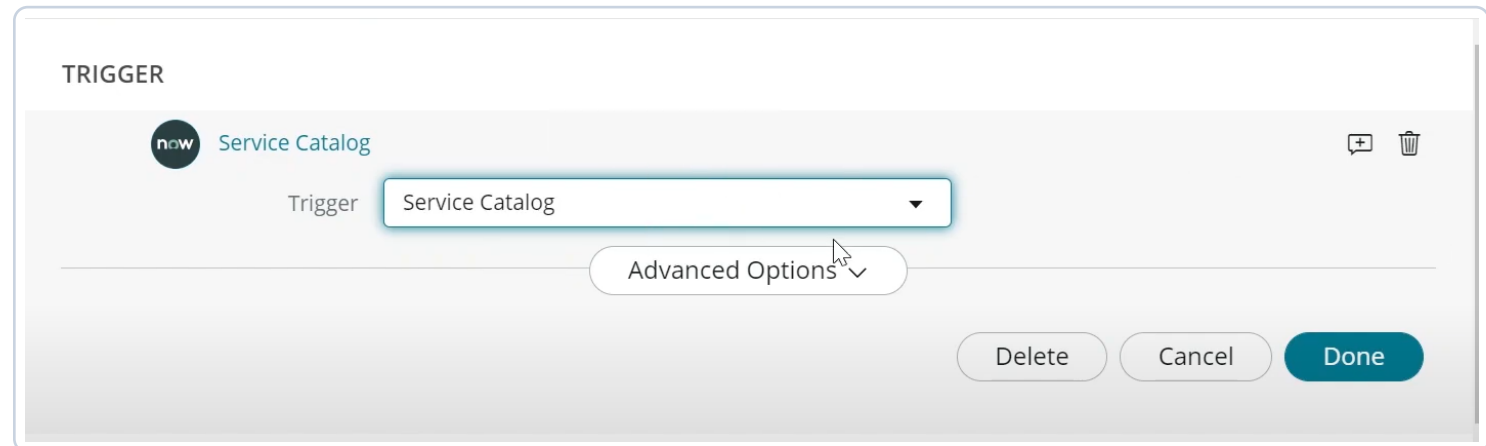
Step 3: Add the Trigger

Milestone 1 | Create the Flow

- 9 Click Add a trigger.
- 10 Search for "Service Catalog" in the trigger list and select it.
- 11 Click Done.



Select a Trigger

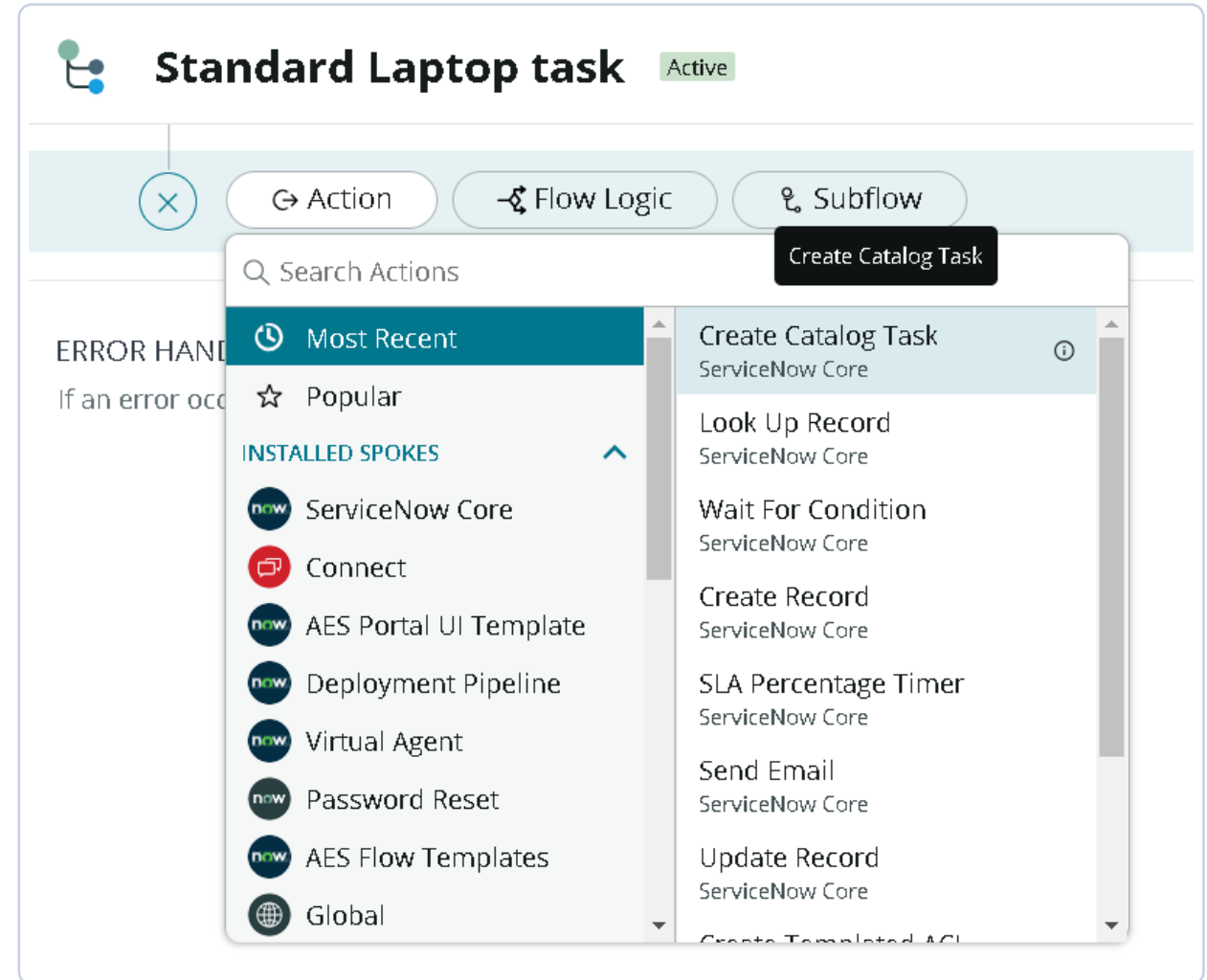


Service Catalog trigger chosen

Step 4: Add the Action

Milestone 1 | Create the Flow

- 12 Under Actions, click Add an action.
- 13 Search for "Create Catalog Task" and select it.
- 14 Mention the details in the action (next slide).



Action picker: Create Catalog Task

Step 5: Configure Create Catalog Task

Milestone 1 | Create the Flow

- 15 Action: Create Catalog Task.
- 16 Drag and drop the Requested Item record into Requested Item.
- 17 Table auto-populates as Catalog Task.
- 18 Short description: "Laptop need to Configured".
- 19 Click Add field value: Description = "Laptop need to Configured".
- 20 Assignment group = Hardware.
- 21 Approval = Approved.
- 22 Leave the rest as default and click Done.

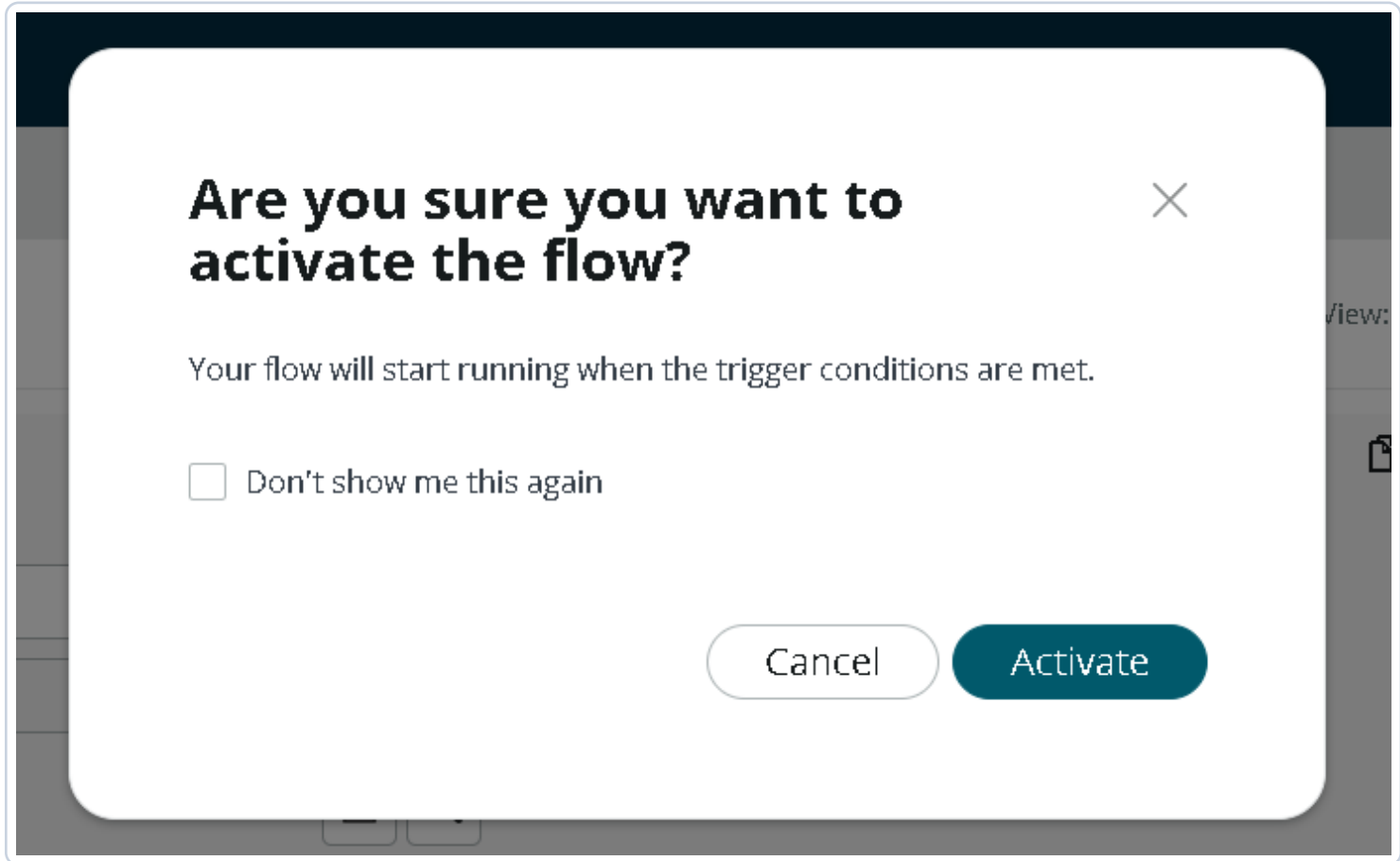
The screenshot displays the 'Standard Laptop task' configuration page in ServiceNow. The page title is 'Standard Laptop task' with an 'Active' status. The configuration is for a 'Create Catalog Task' action. The 'Table Name' is set to 'Catalog Task [sc_task]'. The 'Requested Item [Requested Item]' field is populated with 'Trigger - ... Requested Item ...'. The 'Short Description' is 'Laptop needs to Configured'. The 'Fields' section contains three rows: 'Description' with the value 'Laptop needs to Configured', 'Assignment group' with the value 'Hardware', and 'Approval' with the value 'Approved'. There is a '+ Add field value' button below the fields. The 'Wait' checkbox is checked. The 'Template Catalog' field is partially visible at the bottom.

Create Catalog Task configuration

Step 6: Save and Activate

Milestone 1 | Create the Flow

- 25 Click Save on the flow.
- 26 Click Activate, then click Activate again to confirm.
- 27 The status changes to Active and the flow runs whenever the trigger conditions are met.



Activation confirmation

Step 7: Assign Flow to the Catalog Item

Milestone 2 | Flow Assignment

- 1 Open ServiceNow.
- 2 Click All and search for Maintain Items; select it.
- 3 Search the Name field for Standard Laptop and open that record.
- 4 Open the Process Engine tab.
- 5 Remove the remaining automations and add Flow.
- 6 Select the flow "Standard Laptop Task".
- 7 Save the record from the menu.

Name	Short description	Active	Roles	Catalogs	Category	Price	Type	Updated
Standard Laptop	Lenovo - Carbon x1	true		Service Catalog	Hardware	\$1,100.00	Item	2024-04-16 04:14:53
Standard 27" Monitor	Size - 27", Resolution - 1920x1080, ...	true		Service Catalog	Peripherals	\$0.00	Item	2022-11-20 20:46:33
Standard 22" Monitor	Full HD, IPS Panel with VGA, HDMI, DVI, ...	true		Service Catalog	Peripherals	\$200.00	Item	2016-03-08 16:49:50
Standard 24" Monitor	TUV-certified Monitor Has Flicker-free S...	true		Service Catalog	Peripherals	\$292.28	Item	2022-11-20 20:46:33

Maintain Items > Standard Laptop

Standard Laptop

Name: Standard Laptop

Application: Global

Catalogs: Service Catalog

Category: Hardware

State: -- None --

Checked out: -- None --

Owner:

Active: ☒

Fulfillment automation level: Unspecified

Item Details | **Process Engine** | Picture | Pricing | Portal Settings

Select the appropriate process engine for the catalog item. Only one engine can be selected.

Flow: Standard Laptop task

Workflow:

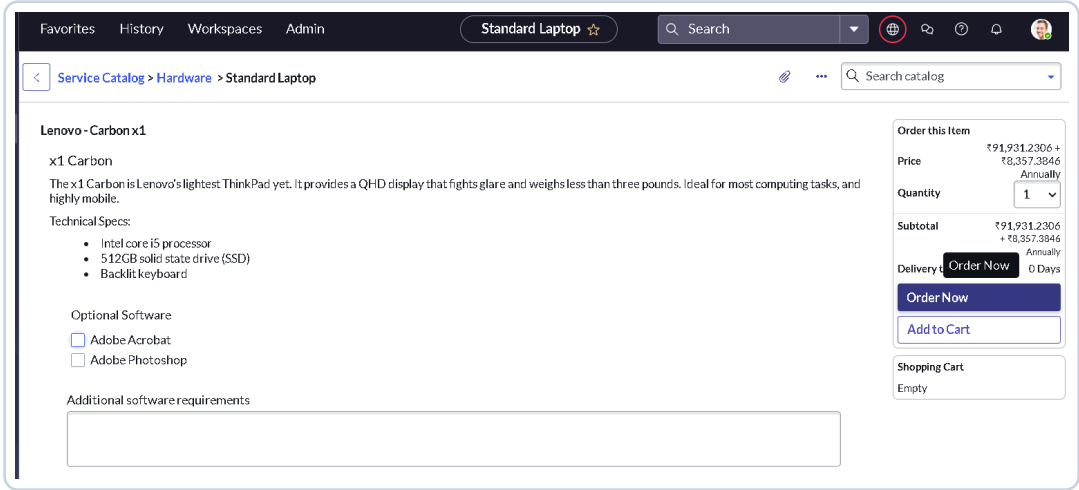
Execution Plan:

Update | Copy | Try It | Edit in Catalog Builder | Delete

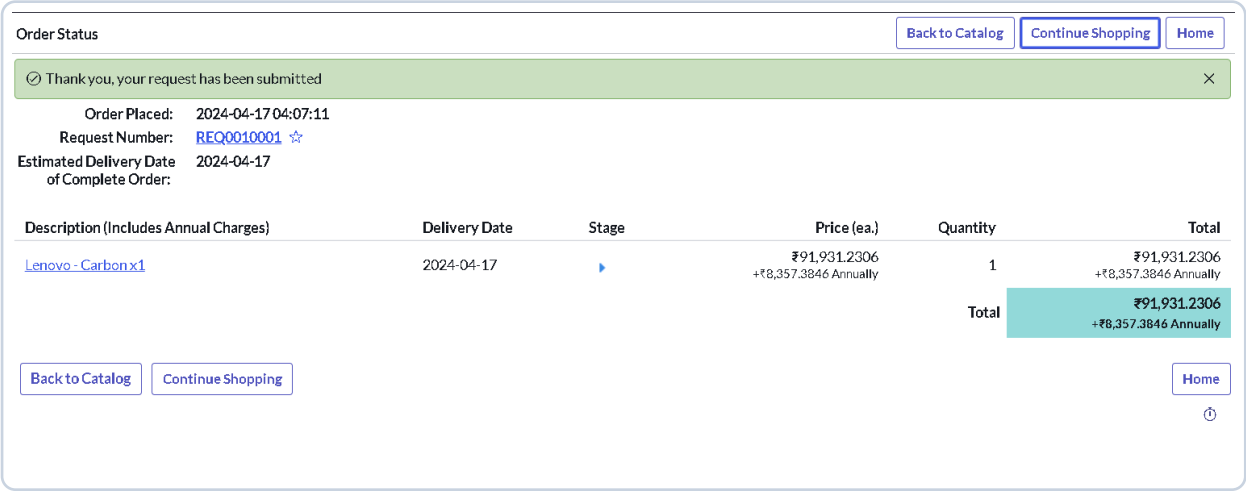
Process Engine tab with the flow attached

Step 8: Place the Order

- 1 Click All and search for Service Catalog.
- 2 Open Service Catalog > Hardware.
- 3 Scroll to Standard Laptop and click it.
- 4 Click Order Now to place the request.
- 5 The Order Status page appears; click the Request Number.



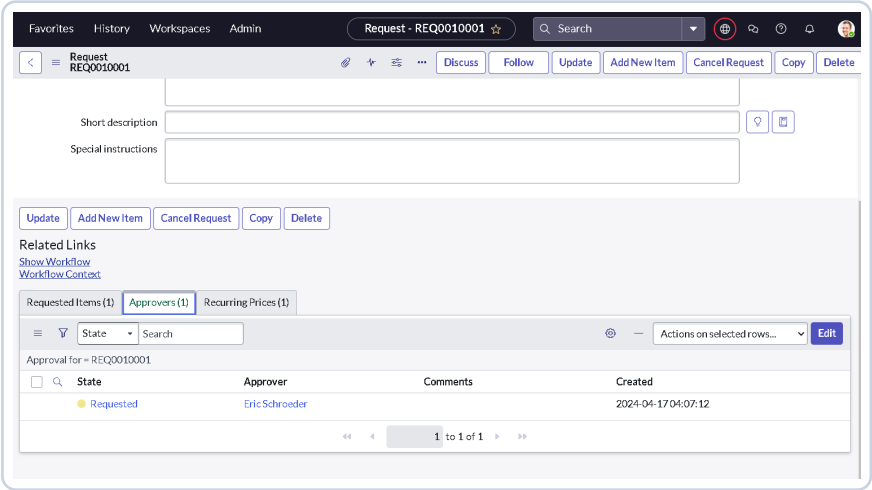
Standard Laptop item: Order Now



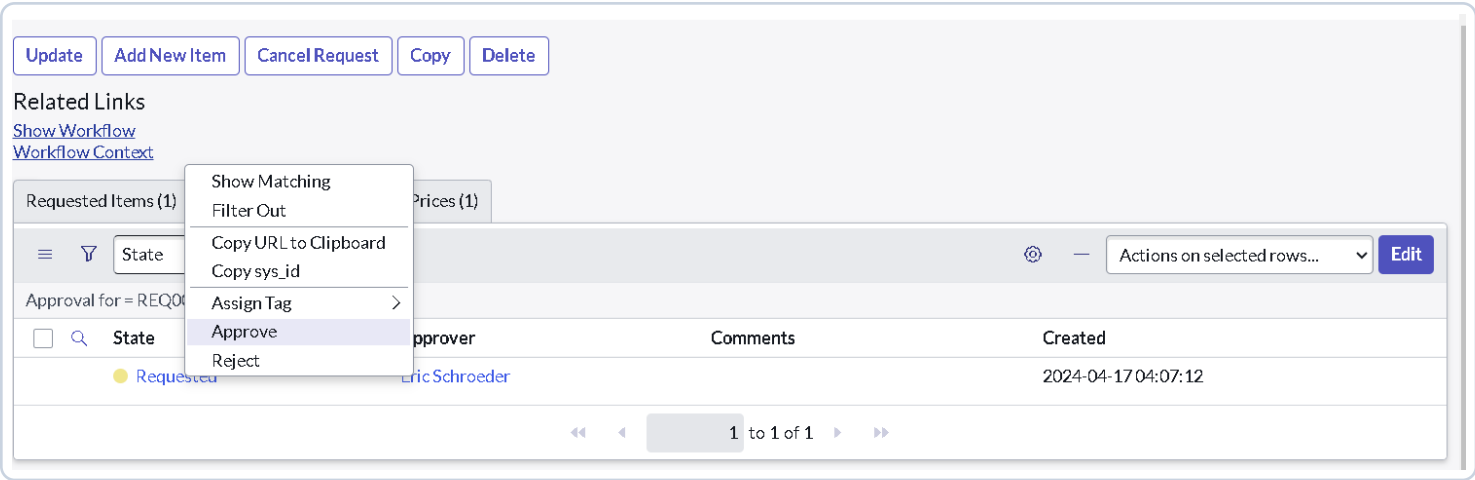
Order Status page

Step 9: Approve the Request

- 6 The Request record opens (e.g. REQ0010001).
- 7 Scroll down and open the Approvers section.
- 8 Right-click the approval record and click Approve.



Approvers tab: state Requested



Right-click > Approve

Demo: Flow Runs After Approval

Demo | How it works

- 1 Open the Requested Item (RITM0010001) from the Request.
- 2 Scroll to the Catalog Tasks section.
- 3 The flow has automatically created SCTASK0010001.
- 4 Assignment group: Hardware
- 5 Short description: Laptop needs to be Configured

Requested Item - RITM0010001

Activities: 1

System Administrator

Field changes • 2024-04-17 04:07:10

- Impact: 3 - Low
- Opened by: System Administrator
- Priority: 4 - Low
- State: Open

Update Delete

Related Links

[Flow Context](#)

Catalog Tasks {1} | Approvers | Group approvals

Request item = RITM0010001

Number	Assignment group	Assigned to	Short description	Actual start	Actual end	Order
SCTASK0010001	Hardware	(empty)	Laptop needs to Configured	2024-04-17 04:11:40	(empty)	

« 1 to 1 of 1 »»

Requested Item with auto-created Catalog Task

Demo: The Generated Catalog Task

Demo | How it works

- 6 Open the Catalog Task record to see the result.
- 7 Approval: Approved
- 8 Short description and Description: Laptop needs to Configured
- 9 Request item: RITM0010001
- 10 State: Open, ready for the Hardware team to configure the laptop.

The screenshot displays a web application interface for a 'Catalog Task' with ID 'SCTASK0010001'. The interface includes a top navigation bar with a back arrow, a menu icon, the task title, and action buttons: 'Discuss', 'Follow', 'Update', 'Close Task', and 'Delete'. The main form is organized into two columns. The left column contains fields for 'Number' (SCTASK0010001), 'Assigned to' (with a search icon), 'Configuration item' (with a search icon), 'Active' (checked checkbox), 'Short description' (Laptop needs to Configured), 'Description' (Laptop needs to Configured), and 'Worknotes' (Work notes). The right column contains dropdown menus for 'Approval' (Approved), 'Priority' (4 - Low), and 'State' (Open), along with search fields for 'Request item' (RITM0010001) and 'Requested for' (System Administrator). Information icons are present next to the search fields. At the bottom right of the form is a 'Post' button. A footer section shows 'Activities: 1' and a filter icon.

Catalog Task SCTASK0010001

Demo Recap: End to End

Demo | How it works

1. Order

Order Status Back to Catalog Continue Shopping Home

Thank you, your request has been submitted

Order Placed: 2024-04-17 04:07:11
Request Number: REQ0010001
Estimated Delivery Date of Complete Order: 2024-04-17

Description (Includes Annual Charges)	Delivery Date	Stage	Price (ea.)	Quantity	Total
Lenovo Carbon x1	2024-04-17		\$91,931.2306 +18,357.3846 Annually	1	\$91,931.2306 +18,357.3846 Annually
Total					\$91,931.2306 +18,357.3846 Annually

Back to Catalog Continue Shopping Home

2. Approve

Update Add New Item Cancel Request Copy Delete

Related Links
[Show Workflow](#)
[Workflow Context](#)

Requested Items (1)

State	Prices (1)	Actions on selected rows...	Edit
Approval for = REQ0010001			
Requester	Eric Schroeder		
Approver			
Comments			
Created	2024-04-17 04:07:12		

1 to 1 of 1

3. Auto task

Favorites History Workspaces Admin Requested Item - RITM0010001 Search Discuss Follow Update Delete

Activities: 1 System Administrator Field changes: 2024-04-17 04:07:10

Impact: 3 - Low
Opened by: System Administrator
Priority: 4 - Low
State: Open

Update Delete

Related Links
[Flow Context](#)

Catalog Tasks (1) Approvers Group approvals

Request Item = RITM0010001

Number	Assignment group	Assigned to	Short description	Actual start	Actual end	Order
SCTASK0010001	Hardware	(empty)	Laptop needs to be configured	2024-04-17 04:11:40	(empty)	

1 to 1 of 1

- User orders a Standard Laptop and the request goes for approval.
- As soon as the request is approved, the Flow Designer flow fires.
- A Catalog Task is created and assigned to Hardware with no manual effort.

Conclusion

By automating the standard laptop procurement process with ServiceNow's Flow Designer, the project addresses inefficiencies and reduces manual overhead. The workflow ensures timely configuration of laptops, minimises user wait times, and improves productivity within the IT department. It also optimises resource allocation and delivers a seamless, efficient procurement experience.

Automated

Task creation needs no manual step

Faster

Shorter wait for configured laptops

Efficient

Hardware team gets work instantly

Thank You

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Sanjay | Krithick | Selva Bharath | Tharun | Rohith